

PROBLEM STATEMENT

African communities, particularly younger generations and diaspora populations, face a rapid erosion of their rich oral heritage as modernization and digital globalization overshadow traditional storytelling. This loss threatens cultural identity, ancestral wisdom, and linguistic diversity. Addressing this is crucial because folktales are foundational vessels of moral education, communal history, and indigenous knowledge. To tackle this, our project introduces a domain-specific Small Language Model (SLM) trained to curate, contextualize, and share authentic African folktales responsibly. Guided by the core values of cultural preservation, inclusivity, transparency, and respect for indigenous intellectual property, our solution amplifies authentic voices rather than replacing them. We hope to foster a renewed appreciation for African heritage, strengthen intergenerational bonds, and provide educators and children with accessible, culturally resonant digital resources that celebrate and safeguard our shared ancestral legacy.